

OUR VOICES AGAINST HARASSMENT

ANNUAL
REPORT
2023

LIST OF ACRONYMS/ABBREVIATIONS

CSR - Corporate Social Responsibility

GBV - Gender-Based Violence

HIV - Human Immune Virus

HRE - Human Rights Education

LGA - Local Government Authority

MoCDGWSG - Ministry of Community

Development, Gender, Women, and Special
Groups

NGO - Non-Governmental Organization

OVAH - Our Voices Against Harassment

PWDs - Persons with Disabilities

SDGs - Sustainable Development Goals

SGBV - Sexual and Gender-Based Violence

VAC - Violence Against Children

VAW - Violence Against Women

VAWC - Violence Against Women and Children



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INTRODUCTION



Our Voices Against Harassment is a non-profit organization based in Tanzania with the registration number 00NGO/R/2053 dedicated to ending violence against women and children and creating a gender-just and violence-free society. We raise awareness about VAWG in our societies, promote the culture of reporting, and work to eliminate negative social norms that perpetuate violence against women and girls.



OUR VISION

To create a gender-just and violence-free nation.



OUR MISSION

Our mission is to protect and empower women, youth, girls, and children by combating sexual violence and advancing their rights across social, economic, and environmental domains.

INTRODUCTION

OUR OBJECTIVES

The following are the objectives that we strive for:

- Strive to eliminate all forms of exploitation, discrimination, and violence against women and children in Tanzania.
- Provide victims of SGBV with comprehensive support, including psychological support and legal services to ensure their emotional and mental health recovery.
- Champion for policies and partnerships that will create a violence-free environment for children and women in our communities.
- To build a country with zero tolerance for SGBV and upholds and protects the rights of children and women emphasizing their right to a healthy and safe life.
- Advancing women’s power, agency, and leadership in diverse sectors including but not limited to economic, social political spheres
- Promote equality and advance women’s rights at all levels of society.

OUR CORE VALUES

- Service to Others
- Impact and Innovation
- Empowerment
- Collective Care
- Learning and Collaboration
- Social Justice



I. WHAT WE DO

AWARENESS AND ADVOCACY

We raise public awareness about the prevalence and impact of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV). We work to influence cultural and societal attitudes that perpetuates violence by engaging communities in open dialogue, education, and awareness initiatives.

COMPREHENSIVE TRAUMA-INFORMED SUPPORT

We provide holistic support services to survivors of sexual violence, including psychological counseling, and referral for legal assistance and medical care. Our interventions are designed to ensure that survivors have the resources they need to recover and rebuild their lives.

AWARENESS AND ADVOCACY

We implement empowerment-based programs that focus on equipping women, youth, and children—the most vulnerable groups—with the knowledge and skills to assert their rights and ensure their safety. Additionally, we advocate for broader prevention strategies that include policy reforms and the creation of safer institutions.

THEORY OF CHANGE

OUTPUTS

- ✓ Increased individual and collective awareness of SGBV and gender equality.
- ✓ Strengthened community-led advocacy and collective action to prevent SGBV.
- ✓ Reduction in stigma and silence surrounding SGBV, leading to increased reporting and support-seeking behaviors.
- ✓ Increased access to education, life skills training, livelihood opportunities, and economic empowerment programs to women and adolescents.

APPROACHES AND ACTIVITIES

- ✓ Awareness & Education, Le Elimba na Mquruma and Mquruma Simama Animation and development dissemination (in schools and media)
- ✓ Community Engagement, i.e., Jamii Salama Initiative, Teachers to Mentors, 16 Days Campaign.
- ✓ Provision of psychological support to survivors services and legal support referral
- ✓ Youth and Adolescent Leadership: Co-create solutions with adolescent girls and boys to impart knowledge and foster leadership, i.e. Elimba Champions
- ✓ Skills Building and Economic Empowerment, i.e., SafeYaru Training Program, Pink Baggi Initiative.

ASSUMPTIONS

- ✓ Increased awareness and education will lead to shifts in attitudes and behaviors over time.
- ✓ Communities are willing and able to engage in meaningful dialogue and action to address SGBV.
- ✓ Women and girls, when empowered, can effectively advocate for themselves and lead change in their communities.
- ✓ Government policies and legal frameworks are enforceable and responsive to advocacy efforts.
- ✓ Social norms and deeply ingrained beliefs can be transformed through sustained, multi-sectoral interventions.

INTERMEDIATE OUTCOMES

- ✓ A shift in mindsets, attitudes, and behaviors that sustain VAWC and SGBV.
- ✓ Strengthened prevention, reporting, & response mechanisms for VAWC & SGBV.
- ✓ Enhanced access to survivor-centered health, legal, and justice services.
- ✓ Effective implementation of institutional and national policies and laws addressing SGBV.
- ✓ A resilient, empowered generation of women and children advocating for their rights and protection.

LONG-TERM OUTCOMES

- ✓ Transformation of harmful gender norms and cultural practices.
- ✓ Establishment of safe, inclusive spaces in schools, homes, and public environments.
- ✓ Decrease in cases of VAWC and SGBV due to strengthened prevention and response efforts.
- ✓ Increased agency, autonomy, and leadership of women and children.
- ✓ Meaningful participation of women and marginalized groups in decision-making at all levels.

PRECONDITIONS

- ✓ OVAH is adequately resourced (financially, technically, and operationally) to implement programs effectively.
- ✓ Government support in enabling civil society work, including permits, partnerships, and policy alignment.
- ✓ The willingness of stakeholders (women, youth, men, local leaders) to engage in conversations and take action against SGBV.
- ✓ Multi-Sectoral Collaboration: Effective coordination between government agencies, NGOs, donors, and grassroots organizations.

VISION

A gender-just, violence-free society where women and girls live free from fear, discrimination, and violence.



II. OUR PROGRAMS AND PROJECTS

ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA : CHAMPIONING FOR SAFE SCHOOLS

Elimika na Mwajuma, an animation initiated in 2022 marked a significant milestone for OVAH’s commitment to combat gender-based violence and promote safe institutions. In 2023, the project evolved into Championing for Safe institutions, broadening its impact across five schools, Kwembe Secondary, Mnazi Mmoja Secondary, Mchikichini Secondary, Mashujaa Secondary and Tandika Secondary schools in Dar es Salaam. The project, Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution Championing for Safe Schools aimed to change the mindsets and attitudes of people towards Sexual Corruption, Early Marriage, Intimate-Partner Violence, Rape Culture and other forms of Gender-Based Violence.



THE PROJECT’S CORE OBJECTIVES;

- Foster open conversations about traditionally taboo subjects, such as sextortion, rape culture, consent, GBV, and victim-blaming, with an aim to break the silence around these critical issues and cultivate a culture of openness and understanding.
- Promote a supportive environment that encourages the reporting of SGBV incidents.
- Empower girls and boys with knowledge about the legislation in place to protect them, their rights, and the resources available to them.

A CAPACITY BUILDING FOR TEACHERS

Prior to the project start, OVAH hosted a preparatory event for the “Championing Safe Institution” project, bringing together 11 teachers from five secondary schools and one university in Dar es Salaam. Representatives from various schools and the Institute of Social Workers actively participated in the event

NAME OF SCHOOL/ UNIVERSITY	PARTICIPANTS
Kwembe Secondary School	Vicky and Anselemi Mashimba
Mnazi Mmoja Secondary School	Victoria Njovu and
Mchikichini Secondary School	Zainab Suleiman and Raphael Nyawenga
Mashujaa Secondary School	Hadija Idrisa Mahanyu and Fadhili
Tandika Secondary School	Ngomuo and Shaweji Abdallah
Institute of Social Workers	Humphrey and Clara clemence

This initiative aimed to address Sexual-Gender Based Violence (SGBV) within educational institutions, recognizing the crucial role teachers play as primary protectors of students. During this gathering, educators were introduced to the comprehensive framework of the Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution Project. The event provided detailed information on project activities, scheduling, student requirements, and awareness modules aligned with Elimika na Mwajuma's content.

The central objective was to actively engage teachers with the project's design and organizational structure, emphasizing their pivotal roles in ensuring its success. Additionally, the event facilitated feedback from teachers, allowing for strategic adjustments and enhancements.

KEY ACTIVITIES DURING THE EVENT INCLUDED;

- i) Presentation of the teaching matrix
- ii) Screening of Elimika na Mwajuma
- iii) Scheduling visitation dates and times in alignment with school timetables
- iv) Conducting a feedback session to gain teachers' insights and suggestions, contributing to the overall improvement of the project.
- v) A networking session fostered collaboration and idea-sharing among teachers,

This preparatory event marked a significant step toward fostering collaboration with educators, ensuring their active involvement in the Elimika na Mwajuma project. It underscores our commitment to creating safe schools and a conducive learning environment free from the grip of gender-based violence.



DISSEMINATION OF ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA

Students and School staff in 5 schools, including mchinikini Secondary School, Mashujaa Secondary School, Mnazi Mmoja Secondary School, Kwembe Secondary School, and Tandika Secondary School were involved in combating SGBV and creating a safe environment in their schools. By integrating Elimika na Mwajuma animations, comprehensive workshops, and the creation of knowledge products such as songs and visual art, the project has empowered over 1,100 students to actively engage in dialogues around sensitive issues including sexual corruption, early marriage, intimate-partner violence, and rape culture.

Throughout the project, students actively participated in lessons, leading to the creation of innovative and creative guides and materials. These student-generated resources encapsulated the invaluable lessons derived from animations and training sessions, empowering students to become active contributors and reinforcing their comprehension of the critical issues addressed. By arming both students and teachers with the knowledge and tools to prevent and respond to Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV), the project successfully cultivated a culture of accountability and collective action within educational institutions.

The culmination of our efforts was evident as the student-created guides, or knowledge products, were launched and showcased during the 16 days of activism against GBV (November 25 to December 10).



ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA SIMAMA DISTRIBUTION FOR SAFE SCHOOLS				
DATE	SCHOOL NAMES	FEMALE	MALE	TOTAL
16/8	Mchikichini	210	190	400
16/8	Kwembe	90	47	137
17/8	M/Mmoja	88	74	162
17/8	Mashujaa	56	116	172
16/8	Tandika	143	75	218
TOTAL		587	502	1089

SEXUAL AWARENESS AND PREVENTION WORKSHOPS IN MWANZA

School-based interventions offer a significant opportunity to address violence against children and adolescents on a large scale, given their ability to reach a wide range of students, teachers who are also parents within their communities. Through these sessions, we educate participants on recognizing different forms of SGBV, we also provide guidance on reporting SGBV incidents and encourage survivors to seek support. Moreover, our workshops challenge deeply ingrained gender and social norms that perpetuate violence, striving to reshape mindsets and behaviors toward gender equality.

It is worth mentioning that, historically, urban areas have received more attention and resources in terms of addressing gender-based violence due to factors such as higher population density, better infrastructure, and easier access to services. However, rural areas, including the Lake Zone Regions (Mwanza, Shinyanga, Geita, Mara, Kagera), often face challenges related to geographical remoteness, limited resources, and cultural norms. These challenges can hinder the implementation of interventions and services to combat gender-based violence. Through our expansion project in Mwanza, we strived to challenge and transform the existing status quo of violence against girls and women and the societal constructs that contribute to gender-based violence in these communities.

In 2023, OVAH engaged seven government schools namely Kileleni Secondary School, Mwagi Secondary School, Lake B Primary School, Lake A Primary School, Ole Njoolay Secondary School, Mwabilanda Primary School, and Taalo Secondary School. We impacted a total of 1314 students including 854 girls and 464 boys.



II. OUR PROGRAMS AND PROJECTS

The following table illustrates the number of educational institutions and students that participated in our Sexual Violence Awareness and Prevention Workshop conducted in Mwanza in three districts namely Kwimba and Magu.

Date	Institution	Type of Institution	No. of Workshops	No. of Female Students	No. of Male Students	Total Participants
08/05/2023	Kileleni	Secondary School	1	69	41	110
09/05/2023	Mwagi	Secondary School	1	205	104	309
09/05/2023	Lake B	Primary School	1	66	23	89
09/05/2023	Lake A	Primary School	1	68	25	93
10/05/2023	Ole Njoolay	Secondary School	1	221	5	226
11/05/2023	Mwabilanda	Primary School	1	71	56	127
11/05/2023	Taalo	Secondary School	1	154	206	350
TOTAL				854	460	1314

Additionally, we also convened teacher and parents which proved to be a valuable mechanism for acquiring and examining profound insights pertaining to SGBV, its responses, and preventive measures. Through the meetings, we were able to pinpoint and address prevailing misconceptions and knowledge gaps among educators and caregivers.

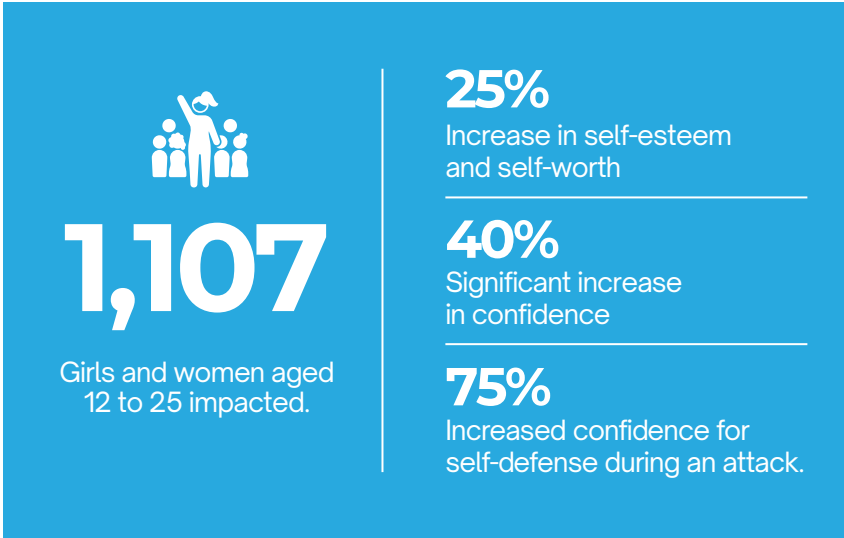


II. OUR PROGRAMS AND PROJECTS

SAFETYETU: EMPOWERMENT SELF-DEFENSE PROGRAM

OVAH's commitment to ensuring the safety and empowerment of girls and women extended beyond the Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution to Champion Safe Schools Project. Complementing these efforts, OVAH implemented the SafetYetu: Empowerment Self-Defense Program in the schools involved. At OVAH, we firmly believe in empowering children by teaching them how to protect themselves, particularly in the face of potential assault.

In 2023, we've equipped 1,107 girls and women aged 12 to 25 with self-defense training, imparting essential skills such as assertiveness, verbal confrontation, and physical techniques to protect themselves from violent assaults. In addition, our pre and post surveys conducted for this program in 2023 demonstrate tangible improvements: a 40% increase in confidence, a 25% increase in self-esteem and self-worth, and a 75% increase in confidence in defending oneself in case of an attack.



Our SafetYetu program has had a significant impact on students, ensuring their safety at school, on the way to school, at home, and within their communities. For instance, Abdulaziz Amani, a student from Mnazi Mmoja, exemplifies the program's success. Inspired by the self-defense skills acquired, Abdulaziz took the initiative to educate his fellow age mates in the community on ways to protect themselves against mild sexual attacks. This ripple effect showcases how empowering students with self-defense not only enhances their personal safety but transforms them into advocates and educators within their communities, contributing to a safer and more resilient society.



II. OUR PROGRAMS AND PROJECTS

SUPPORT SERVICE PROGRAM

In the year 2023, Our Voices Against Harassment made significant strides in addressing the challenges faced by survivors of Gender-Based Violence (GBV) in Tanzania. The organization proactively responded to the scarcity of mental health professionals, recognizing the critical need for accessible mental health care services. With only 0.17 psychologists per 100,000 population in Tanzania (World Health Organization, Mental Health Atlas 2017), Our Voices Against Harassment strategically undertook legal literacy initiatives and community outreach to empower citizens with a deeper understanding of their rights, overcoming barriers hindering access to justice and support services.

A pivotal moment in this journey was the Reimagining Survivor Support Personnel Event held on July 22nd, 2023, at the American Corner. This gathering celebrated the invaluable contributions of 22 support personnel, legal practitioners, and psychologists, offering a platform to deepen the organization's understanding of GBV support services. Insights gained from experienced support personnel played a crucial role in refining and elevating the quality of support services. The event also marked the implementation of new communication tools and geographical availability mapping, significantly expanding accessibility to support services.



Our Voices Against Harassment strategically expanded support services to regions with high GBV rates, including Kagera, Mwanza, and Ruvuma. This approach not only fostered a culture of volunteerism among experts but also aligned with the organization's overarching goal of promoting a safer and more compassionate society, free from the grip of gender-based violence.



In this transformative year, the organization handled four cases involving incidents of sexual violence against victims. Notably, one adult woman in Mbeya, one child in Kagera, and two children under 12 years old in Dar es Salaam received essential psychological and legal support services. The committed support personnel team played a vital role in providing invaluable emotional assistance to survivors throughout their healing journeys and pursuit of justice.

One remarkable instance showcased the organization's commitment to justice as it facilitated the transfer of one of the cases to government authorities. Our successful persuasion led the victim's parents to seek additional assistance from the Gender Desk, highlighting the strong partnership between non-governmental organizations and government agencies in the pursuit of justice.

These achievements underscore Our Voices Against Harassment's dedication to creating a safer and more resilient community in 2023, marking a year of transformative impact in the fight against Gender-Based Violence.

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

HEDHI YANGU UJASIRI WANGU' CAMPAIGN

In a momentous achievement, OVAH, in collaboration with esteemed partners including Young and Alive, the Institute of Social Workers, Dkt Tanzania, TACAIDS, and Mariestopes, proudly presents the successful outcome of the 'Hedhi Yangu Ujasiri Wangu' campaign commemorating International Menstrual Hygiene Day on May 28th.

OVAH's team delivered insightful sessions to empower participants on critical topics such as:



Consent

Nurturing an open dialogue to underscore the importance of mutual consent in all interpersonal interactions.

Barriers to Reporting Sexual Abuse

Illuminating the multifaceted challenges hindering victims from reporting their experiences and working towards dismantling these barriers.

Screenings of Elimika na Mwajuma

Thought-provoking screenings of episodes 1 and 3, focusing on Sex Corruption and Rape Culture, sparked meaningful discussions and encouraged critical reflection.

Importance of Reporting

Emphasizing the pivotal role of reporting in seeking justice and creating a safer environment for all.

Support Services for Victims

Providing valuable insights into the array of support services available for victims and survivors of sexual violence, empowering them to seek the assistance they need.

The active engagement and meticulous outreach efforts led to the participation of 117 individuals, with 81 females and 36 males. This collaborative endeavor reinforces OVAH's belief in making a lasting impact, fostering awareness, empathy, and an unwavering commitment to combatting sexual abuse while championing reproductive rights.



117

Individuals
participated

OVAH extends heartfelt gratitude to all partners and participants whose dedication contributed to the resounding success of the 'Hedhi Yangu Ujasiri Wangu' campaign. Our dedication to advancing sexual health and well-being remains steadfast, and we eagerly anticipate continuing this journey towards a safer and more informed community.

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS WEBINAR : CHANGING THE NARRATIVE ON MENTAL HEALTH & SRH.

On May 25th, Our Voices Against Harassment had the privilege of being invited as a speaker to the distinguished webinar organized by the Young & Alive Initiative. The webinar, titled "Changing The Narrative On Mental Health & SRH," aimed to raise awareness about youth mental health and sexual and reproductive health (SRH) in honor of Mental Health Awareness Month.

OVAH's Program Manager was featured as one of the esteemed speakers, leveraging her extensive expertise and wealth of experience in addressing gender-based violence (GBV). We provided a vital perspective on the intricate intersections between GBV and mental health, significantly contributing to the overarching theme of the webinar.



The webinar served as a valuable platform for open and informed discussions, allowing participants to delve into the challenges faced by young individuals in the realms of mental health and SRH. As OVAH we emphasized the importance of societal considerations beyond awareness, highlighting the need to eliminate barriers to the accessibility and affordability of mental health support services in Tanzania.

JAMII IMPACT : EXPLORING LEGAL, ACCOUNTING, AND ANTI-GBV MEASURES

In 2023, our organization (OVAH) achieved a significant milestone with the successful implementation of Jamii Impact: Exploring Legal, Accounting, and Anti-GBV Measures. On September 16th, 2023, we actively participated in the Jamii Impact educational workshop. The primary objective of this workshop was to offer valuable insights into the requirements and standards governing the education sector, as outlined by the Tanzanian Government and other relevant authorities.



The workshop centered on empowering educators in three crucial areas:

- ☒ Legal and regulatory framework
- ☒ Book-keeping and accounting
- ☒ Anti-GBV (Gender-Based Violence) workshops.

In collaboration with Jamii Impact, we played a key role in delivering Gender-Based Violence (GBV) training to schools that are recipients of their loans.

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

During this event, we successfully educated teachers, lawyers, and accountants involved in the Shule Loan project about gender-based violence. Furthermore, we outlined OVAH's advocacy efforts against GBV and elucidated on the support we provide to survivors. Our organization effectively guided school administrators and teachers on the significance of establishing school policies to educate students about GBV. We emphasized the importance of implementing reporting mechanisms for SGBV, aiming to create safe schools and cultivate a shift in mindset and behavior that rejects GBV in schools, homes, and communities.



In addition, we engaged lawyers in a thoughtful discussion, posing key questions to gain insights into GBV cases in Tanzania. This valuable information enabled us to better navigate support services, offering assistance to those seeking support in the subsequent months of 2023. The success of Jamii Impact underscored our commitment to making a positive impact in the realms of education, legal and accounting practices, and the fight against Gender-Based Violence.

SIKU YA MTOTO WA KIKE (INTERNATIONAL DAY OF THE GIRL CHILD) WITH VIJANA THINK TANK

Our organization celebrated the International Day of the Girl Child on October 13, 2023. Additionally, we successfully established a valuable partnership with the Vijana Think Tank to enhance the impact of our event.

The theme for this year's celebration was **"Invest in Girls' Rights: Our Leadership, Our Well Being,"** which resonated throughout the event. Our activities brought together all the girls at the school, accompanied by three dedicated teachers who played significant roles in the proceedings. Notably, one of the teachers courageously assumed the role of a parent, emphasizing the profound impact that teachers can have as surrogate parents in the lives of students.



III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

The event unfolded through a series of engaging activities:



Empowerment Activities. We enlisted the support of Madam Beatrice, a dedicated teacher who willingly assumed the role of a surrogate parent/guardian. With passion and conviction, Madam Beatrice passionately conveyed invaluable insights to the female students. She eloquently stressed the profound significance of education and highlighted potential consequences associated with premature engagement in sexual activities. Emphasizing the need for a comprehensive understanding of its effects, Madam Beatrice also shed light on the insidious impact of a culture of silence in the ve context of gender-based violence (GBV). She urged the students to prioritize their education and remain vigilant against the subtle influences of men within their communities.



Open Discussion. We facilitated an open mic discussion involving students, teachers, representatives from non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and guardian representatives. The guiding question was, "Ni kwa namna gani jamii inaweza wekeza katika uwongozi, haki, na ustawi wa wasichana nchini Tanzania" (In what ways can the community invest in the leadership, justice, and well-being of girls in Tanzania?). During this discussion, students provided insights into how the government and NGOs could invest in their education, career paths, and support services. Teachers highlighted their roles in providing education to female students and being their guiding support in their career paths. Our Voices Against Harassment emphasized our collaborative dedication to establishing safe spaces and platforms to amplify girls' voices. Moreover, we advocated for gender equity, gender justice, and a violence-free nation.



Pedagogy in GBV. With a focus on pedagogy in Gender-Based Violence (GBV), we challenged the students to use pedagogical methods to express their thoughts on a crucial question: "How can we invest in the rights, leadership, and well-being of girls in Tanzania?" The highlight of the day was a poignant and thought-provoking drama staged by the students. The drama revolved around the theme of child marriage, shedding light on the harsh realities that some girls face and suggesting ways to support them in avoiding such situations. The students' performance was not only dramatic but also deeply reflective of the challenges and aspirations of girls in Tanzania.

Following the gripping drama, two students, one boy and one girl, stepped forward to articulate their rights as students and children. They passionately emphasized the pivotal role of education in shaping their leadership abilities, not only for personal growth but also to contribute meaningfully to their families and communities.

The event created a powerful atmosphere where the students' voices were heard, and their creativity flourished. It served as a platform for insightful discussions on the importance of investing in girls' rights, leadership, and well-being, leaving a lasting impact on everyone present. Our Voices Against Harassment, through its strategic planning and collaboration, successfully orchestrated an event that not only celebrated the International Day of the Girl Child but also ignited a spark for positive change in the lives of girls in Tanzania

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

16 DAYS OF ACTIVISM AGAINST GENDER BASED VIOLENCE

The 16 Days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence (GBV) is a yearly global effort that begins on November 25, known as the International Day for the Elimination of Violence against Women, and lasts until December 10 - Human Rights Day. In particular, this campaign emphasizes that violence against women, in any form, is a violation of human rights.

OVAH Tanzania with a steering committee of 25 organizations are planning a campaign for the 16 Days of Activism against GBV in Tanzania in eight regions: Dar es Salaam, Zanzibar, Mtwara, Tabora, Ausha, Dodoma, Singida and Morogoro. We aim to work with girls and women, law enforcement personnel, social workers, healthcare professionals, community leaders, educational institutions, the media, the government and the society as a whole. Some of these are stakeholders and beneficiaries have the power to make change including the government officials who can enact policy changes and enforce laws, community leaders who influence societal norms, educational institutions that shape young minds and promote gender equality, media outlets that can shape public opinion and challenge stereotypes, law enforcement personnel who respond to sGBV cases, and healthcare professionals who can identify and support survivors. Collaborating with and influencing these stakeholders is essential to effectively address SGBV and ensure the success of the campaign.



Our intervention seeks to empower girls and women with knowledge of their rights. Enhance the capacity of traditional elders and community leaders, empowering them to become advocates against SGBV and challenging traditional power structures which result in changes at the grassroots level, leading to more inclusive and supportive communities. Through media campaigns and online campaigns, We aim to sensitize a significant portion of the population to the issue of SGBV and the legal protections available to women and children. Ultimately, this awareness will lead to increased public support for policy changes and legal reforms that protect women's rights. This collaborative and multifaceted approach strengthens the collective power to effect change, ultimately contributing to advancing women's human rights.

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

This year's global campaign theme, "Supporting and investing in women's rights organizations is key to ending violence against women and girls," was contextualized to "**Tuungane kujenga Jamii Salama: Tanzania Bila Ukatili wa Kijinsia Inawezekana**" (Let's unite to build a safe community: Tanzania without gender-based violence is possible).

Our main campaign objective was to combat and reduce GBV through a multifaceted approach, including awareness-raising, creating a supportive reporting environment, increasing community engagement, disseminating knowledge, adopting innovative approaches, and enhancing legal frameworks. Meanwhile our specific objective included;

- Enhance awareness and challenge deeply-rooted social and cultural norms perpetuating violence against women and children in Tanzania.
- Create a supportive environment for reporting GBV cases by reducing stigma, enhancing social and environmental risk factors, and improving GBV response mechanisms.
- Increase community engagement and participation in the crusade against violence against women and children, fostering a sense of collective responsibility.
- Disseminate knowledge on the intricate connections between gender-based violence and other issues such as migration, climate change, and natural disasters.
- Identify, adopt, showcase, and strengthen innovative approaches to combat gender-based violence in Tanzania.
- Enhance legal frameworks to safeguard women's rights and advocate for accessible policies and comprehensive reporting mechanisms, involving all stakeholders, from government agencies and gender desks to social workers, victims, and law enforcement, in the fight against gender-based violence.

Therefore, through those objective, we managed to plan and implement the following key activities:

- Training sessions in Singida, Tabora, Dar es Salaam, and Arusha to empower stakeholders in GBV awareness, response, and intervention
- Conducted informative educational sessions in Zanzibar and Dar es Salaam to raise awareness about women's rights and the legal framework against GBV.
- Executed a media awareness campaign reaching millions through various platforms, addressing issues such as sex trafficking, early child marriage, and the culture of silence.
- Engaged traditional elders in combating violence in marginalized communities of Arusha, Zanzibar, and Mtwara.
- Documented the stories of 5 GBV survivors in Dar es Salaam and Dodoma presented in audio formats to advocate for policy changes and raise awareness while prioritizing privacy and consent.
- Organized a Daring Voices Gathering on December 8th, empowering 150+ youth with panel discussions, activities, and performances for change.
- All partners' marketing teams collaborated in creating shareable materials and encouraging a Twibbonize campaign for individual pledges in the fight against Gender-Based Violence in Tanzania.

III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

OVAH AND PARTNERS' DAR ES SALAAM INITIATIVES DURING THE 16 DAYS OF ACTIVISM AGAINST GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE



In collaboration with OVAH, Binti Hatua Foundation, Islands Care Foundation, FASAT, Girls Up Tanzania, Rise Up Foundation, EmpowerHer, and the Institute of Social Work, we successfully empowered 60 girls and women. Our achievement lies in enhancing their in-depth understanding of their rights and the laws protecting them against SGBV, while also encouraging men to become allies and advocates against GBV. Additionally, we provided information on available support when encountering GBV, including resources such as OVAH, the Gender Desk at the Social Institute, the police station near the Social Institute, and others. This comprehensive initiative was complemented by a bonanza implemented at the Institute of Social Work on December 1st, 2023.

Daring Voices Gathering : Building a Safe Society Together

The Daring Voices Gathering on December 8th marked the pinnacle of the campaign, bringing together over 150 girls, young women, and men. The event featured panel discussions, hands-on activities, and performances to foster understanding, celebrate strengths, and unite stakeholders committed to improving the lives of women and girls. The event showcased OVAH and partners commitment to combating gender-based violence, featuring impactful panels, hands-on activities, and elimika na mwajuma distribution for championing safe schools awards ceremony recognizing contributors to gender equality. The gathering stood as a beacon of success, symbolizing strides towards a safer, inclusive society for young women in Tanzania.



III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

Media Awareness Campaign on GBV

Our outreach efforts effectively raised awareness on various facets of gender-based violence (GBV) within the Tanzanian community. This initiative, a collaboration between Our Voices Against Harassment (OVAH), Binti Hatua Foundation, and Islands Care Foundation (ICF), inspired individuals to advocate for change by fostering shifts in mindset and behavior. The media awareness campaign covered two regions, Dar es Salaam and Tabora, making impactful strides at Azam TV, Mlimani Radio, TBC, and Taa bora Radio. Key topics included the significance of the Global 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-Based Violence, our collaborative campaign against GBV, issues like sex trafficking, early child marriage, the silence culture, and the importance of inclusivity in support services for victims of GBV (both male and female).

16 Days Against GBV Online Campaign

Additionally, an online campaign engaged over 1,000 people in each region from November 25th to December 10th, encouraging pledges to contribute to the fight against GBV.

Daring Voices Gathering : Building A Safe Society Together Event

OVAH Tanzania, achieved a significant milestone in 2023 with the successful execution of the "Daring Voices Gathering: Building a Safe Society Together." Held at Buni Hub on December 8th, this event served as the pinnacle of the 16 Days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence campaign, leaving an indelible mark as one of OVAH's key achievements in 2023.

The gathering, attended by over 150 girls and young women, unfolded seamlessly, creating an atmosphere of empowerment, dialogue, and collective solutions. As an active participant, I witnessed the transformative impact of the event, reflecting OVAH's unwavering commitment to combating gender-based violence in Tanzania.



III. ORGANIZATION HIGHLIGHTS 2023

The day commenced with a warm welcome and an insightful campaign overview, setting the stage for the impactful discussions and activities that followed. Noteworthy was the presence of the event's Guest of Honor ACP Tulibake Kasongwa, accompanied by our phenomenal panelists Mr. Patrick Sarofa, Eng. Juliana Marko, Modesta Joseph, and Dr. Betty Kwoko.

- The first panel, "Own Your Voice: Claiming Autonomy and Purpose," resonated deeply, providing a platform for extraordinary women to share their personal journeys of self-discovery and empowerment. The narratives served as a source of inspiration, encouraging young girls and women to find and amplify their unique voices.
- The second panel, "Innovate for Equality: Women's Leadership Across Sectors," highlighted the pivotal role of women in driving innovation across various fields. Eminent women leaders shared their experiences of breaking barriers, emphasizing the importance of diverse perspectives in shaping solutions. The discussions were a compelling call to action, urging support for and amplification of women's voices in all sectors.
- Hands-on activities, including workshops on self-defense, health and wellness, and design thinking, enriched participants with practical skills and knowledge. The performances curated by the invited students, part of Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution Championing for Safe School Project, added a creative dimension, providing a platform for participants to showcase their talents through poems, plays, and songs.
- The awards ceremony recognized and celebrated knowledge products produced by the students representing the 5 secondary schools.

The Daring Voices Gathering stands out as a beacon of success for OVAH in 2023, symbolizing a collective stride towards a safer and more inclusive society for women and girls in Tanzania. Gratitude is extended to all partners, participants, and contributors who played instrumental roles in making this event a resounding success. OVAH remains steadfast in its dedication to advancing gender equality and eliminating gender-based violence in the years to come



IV: CHALLENGES AND LESSONS LEARNED

- 1

Many survivors and families are still hesitant to report cases of abuse due to stigma, fear of retaliation, or distrust in the legal system. Breaking these barriers requires sustained awareness campaigns and advocacy.
- 2

While OVAH has expanded support services to high-GBV regions like Mwanza; financial and logistical constraints limit how many survivors can be reached. More investment is needed to scale up interventions.
- 3

Despite efforts to facilitate survivor access to justice, delays in legal proceedings and inadequate survivor-centered approaches within the system pose challenges. Strengthening partnerships with legal stakeholders is necessary to improve case resolutions.

V. RECOGNITION

In 2023, OVAH not only screened animation videos in schools but also aired them on TV as finalists for the BASATA Film Awards. This exposure led to the organization receiving six cases of harassment and violence in December 2023.

VI. ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

JAMII Impact Financial Services Limited

JAMII IMPACT provides financial and non-financial services to Micro-, Small-, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) including private nursery and primary schools in Tanzania. We collaborate with Jamii Impact to deliver Gender-Based Violence (GBV) training in schools that receive loans from them. Our training constitutes an integral component of the mandatory criteria schools must fulfill to become eligible for loans granted by Jamii Impact.

Shule Direct

We're delighted to introduce our new friends and supporters, ShuleDirect, who share our vision for a safer, more inclusive society. With ShuleDirect's dynamic online platform, we're now reaching even wider audiences with our impactful content, Elimika na Mwajuma. Through engaging puzzles, quizzes, and open discussions, we're creating spaces for meaningful conversations about Gender-Based Violence where students can learn, question, and grow.

Anti-Human and Child Trafficking Task Force

We are proud to announce our successful partnership with the Anti-Human Trafficking and Child Abuse Task Force, a collaborative organization that unites various authorities including Immigration, the Police Force, Prosecution and Investigation, Safe houses programs, the Ministry of Gender, Children, and Women, among others. They are dedicated to enhancing the efficiency of addressing exploitation cases and ensuring the safety and well-being of vulnerable individuals. This partnership will empower OVAH to offer more immediate assistance in cases with the Police Force and the Court.

Organizing the 16 Days of Activism against GBV with 25+ Organizations

OVAH, in collaboration with numerous partners, is diligently preparing to spearhead the 16 Days of Activism against Gender-Based Violence campaign, a global initiative running from November 25th to December 10th. The campaign's primary goal is to unite organizations from all walks of life in the fight against gender-based violence, emphasizing that such violence is a blatant violation of human rights.

Reene Pads and Femi Care

With a heartfelt appreciation to Reene Pads for donating 30 reusable pads to OVAH during our Daring Voices Gathering Event. The pads were provided to the girls that attended the event that were part of our Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution Championing for Safe Schools project.

VI. ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Pinkbox Initiative

We extend our deepest gratitude for the generous donation of 30 pads received during our Daring Voices Gathering Event. The pads were provided to the girls who attended the event, and they are an essential part of our Elimika na Mwajuma Distribution as we champion for safe schools. Your support through Pinkbox Initiative has made a meaningful impact, ensuring that young girls have access to necessary resources. We are immensely grateful for your commitment to making a difference in our community.

Wadada Solutions

In July 2023, during our organization mapping and impact expansion to the lake region, Mwanza, we got invited by another NGO, Wadada: Solutions on GBV Organization. Wadada is a youth-led NGO that endeavors to empower young individuals to assert their rights and live in a society free from all forms of violence and exploitation. The team members of this organization warmly welcomed us and shared profound insights on topics such as proposal writing, implementing safeguarding policies, and establishing collaborative partnerships with post-crisis networks like fit persons and One Stop centers.

Wote Sawa

Our visit to their organization premises and the subsequent meeting with their team proved to be fruitful. We engaged in meaningful discussions about the initiatives undertaken by various organizations to promote social improvement, particularly in advocating against gender-based violence (GBV). Additionally, we exchanged valuable insights and advice on effective NGO management, grant writing techniques, and fundraising strategies.



2023 IN PICTURES



2023 IN PICTURES



2023 IN PICTURES



SUPPORTERS



KUHUSU ELIMIKA NA MWAJUMA

Elimika na Mwajuma inachangia shule salama katika jamii zetu na Kupinga Unyanyasaji ili kungeza mazingira ya kujifunza bila hofu na Unyanyasaji wa Kiingereza na Kingono.

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